

The Scots Magazine.

BOTHWELL CASTLE.

BY F. MARY COLQUHOUN.

THE west of Scotland is rich in ruined castles of beauty and of historic interest. One of special note is Bothwell in Clydesdale, a grand edifice of the thirteenth century. Most likely it was enlarged during the occupation of the English, and of all the castles of that century may be counted the finest ruin in Scotland.

At that period it was possessed by the De Moravia, or Moray family. The castle was taken by Edward I., and by him made over to Aymer de Valence, Earl of Pembroke, governor of that region of Scotland. It was in the hands of the English a good deal till 1337, when the Scotch retook and dismantled it. The castle then passed by marriage to the Douglasses, and was held by that powerful family till their forfeiture under James II., 1445. Now it belongs to the Earl of Home.

Bothwell is beautifully situated on a rocky headland with steep banks on the south and west of the Clyde's broad waters, while on the north and east it was cut off from the adjoining level land by deep, wide ditches, the outlines of which may still be noted. The castle consists of a large courtyard surrounded by walls of great height, strengthened at the corners with round, square towers, while a donjon of majestic size "dominates" the whole. The length of the building is 325 feet by 140 feet in width. The donjon is a grand